PLATFORM REQUIREMENTS

Discovery Checklist

Fill in · return · we scope Phase 1 from your answers

Company / contact: _____
Industry: _____
Prepared for: _____
Date: _____ Target go-live: _____

HOW TO USE THIS QUIZ

Answer every section you can. Check boxes that apply. Write short answers in the blanks. Attach screenshots or exports where noted. Incomplete is OK - we will clarify on a follow-up call. Your answers shape Phase 1 scope, timeline, and cost.

When you return this, we will send a scoped proposal.

QUICK GLOSSARY (read this first)

Why this matters
Pipeline = the steps a job/deal/case moves through (like columns on a board: Lead -> In progress -> Done).

Why this matters
CRM = your shared list of people + history (who they are, notes, messages, status) - not a personal phone or spreadsheet.

Why this matters
Prospect / lead = someone interested but not a paying customer yet.

Why this matters
Contact (address book) = someone you text/call who is NOT in the sales pipeline (realtor, vendor, event meet).

Why this matters
Portal = a private web login for clients or partners to upload docs, see status, or pay - without emailing files around.

Why this matters
Phase 1 = the first release we build (must-haves). Phase 2 = later upgrades.

Why this matters
Soft-warn vs hard-block = soft-warn says "this phone already exists" but lets you save; hard-block refuses duplicates.

Why this matters
Magic link = login link sent by email/SMS (no password to remember).

01 BUSINESS OUTCOME

Why this matters
Pick the pain that costs you the most time or money today. We use this to order Phase 1.

What problem hurts most today? (pick 1 primary, up to 2 secondary)

- [ ] Leads / pipeline is messy or duplicated across tools
- [ ] Team cannot text/call from a shared business line with history
- [ ] Clients / partners have no portal (or a weak one)
- [ ] Payments / installments / collections are manual
- [ ] Documents and approvals are scattered (email / Drive / WhatsApp)
- [ ] Field crews / mobile staff cannot update status easily
- [ ] Scheduling / reminders are missed
- [ ] Reporting is spreadsheet-only
- [ ] Other: _____

In one sentence, what does "success in 90 days" look like?

Who is the day-to-day owner on your side after launch?

Why this matters
This is the person who answers questions and tests the system - not always the owner who signs the contract.

Name / role: _____

02 WHO USES THE SYSTEM

Why this matters
"Logins" = how many people need their own username to sign in. Partners = outside people (affiliates, realtors), not your employees.

Approximate headcount at launch
Staff logins: _____ Client / customer logins: _____
Partner / vendor / affiliate logins: _____

Roles (check all that apply; add missing ones)

- [ ] Owner / executive
- [ ] Operations / coordinator
- [ ] Sales / intake
- [ ] Field / crew / technician
- [ ] Finance / collections
- [ ] Partner / affiliate / referral source
- [ ] End customer / client portal user
- [ ] Other: _____

For each role you checked, what must they see vs. be blocked from?

Why this matters
Example: "Coordinator sees all jobs; field tech only sees jobs assigned to them."

Mobile needs

- [ ] Office desktop only for now
- [ ] Mobile browser is enough

Why this matters
Mobile browser = works on phone Chrome/Safari, no App Store install.

- [ ] Native app later (Phase 2+)
- [ ] Field staff must update status from phone (photo / text / form)

Languages required

- [ ] English only
- [ ] Spanish only
- [ ] English + Spanish (staff and/or clients)
- [ ] Other: _____

03 PIPELINE / LIFECYCLE STAGES

Why this matters
Write the real steps you use today (even if informal). Example for construction: Award -> Design -> City plan -> Install -> Inspection -> Closeout. Example for sales: New lead -> Quoted -> Won -> Onboarding -> Active.

List the exact stages a job / deal / case moves through, in order

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____
4. _____ 5. _____ 6. _____
7. _____ 8. _____ 9. _____

Do all records use every stage?

- [ ] Yes, always
- [ ] No - some stages are optional. Which? _____

What should happen automatically when a stage changes?

Why this matters
"Automatically" means the system does it without someone remembering - e.g. move to Install and the client gets a reminder SMS.

- [ ] Notify internal owner
- [ ] Notify client / partner
- [ ] Create tasks / checklist
- [ ] Start a reminder sequence
- [ ] Nothing automatic - status only
- [ ] Other: _____

04 PEOPLE & RECORDS (CRM)

Why this matters
Keep sales "pipeline" people separate from a simple phone book when possible - otherwise partners and random contacts clutter your sales board.

What kinds of people do you track? (check all)

- [ ] Prospects / leads (not customers yet)
- [ ] Paying clients / customers
- [ ] Address-book contacts (text/call only - not in sales pipeline)
- [ ] Referral partners (realtors, brokers, affiliates)
- [ ] Vendors / suppliers
- [ ] Crews / subcontractors
- [ ] Other: _____

Must pipeline stay separate from a simple contacts address book?

- [ ] Yes - do not mix partners / random contacts into the sales pipeline
- [ ] No - one list is fine
- [ ] Not sure

Duplicate rules

Why this matters
Soft-warn = "This phone already exists - save anyway?" Hard-block = cannot create a second record with the same phone/email.

- [ ] Soft-warn on matching phone/email, allow save anyway
- [ ] Hard-block duplicates
- [ ] Merge workflow needed

Source of truth today

Why this matters
"Source of truth" = the place you trust when two lists disagree (spreadsheet vs phone vs website).

- [ ] Spreadsheets
- [ ] Existing website / portal (share login or export)
- [ ] HubSpot / Salesforce / other CRM: _____
- [ ] Paper / memory
- [ ] Mix - describe: _____

Should the new platform replace that source of truth?

- [ ] Yes, fully
- [ ] No - sync / coexist
- [ ] Phase 1 replace core only

05 MESSAGING & COMMUNICATIONS

Why this matters
Business SMS/voice means texts and calls go out from a company number and stay logged on the person - not from each employee's personal phone.

Channels needed at launch

- [ ] SMS / MMS from a business number (logged in CRM)
- [ ] Voice calls (browser softphone and/or forward to cell)

Why this matters
Softphone = call from the laptop/browser. Forward to cell = rings your personal phone but still logs in the CRM.

- [ ] Branded email from the platform
- [ ] Internal notes only (no client messaging yet)
- [ ] WhatsApp / social DMs (usually Phase 2+)
- [ ] Other: _____

Who can staff message?

- [ ] Clients / customers
- [ ] Prospects
- [ ] Address-book contacts (non-pipeline)
- [ ] Referral partners
- [ ] Unknown numbers (cold outbound)

Must every outbound message be logged to the person record?

Why this matters
Logging = a note like "SMS sent Tue 2pm" appears on their profile so the team has history.

- [ ] Yes - SMS and email notes auto-saved
- [ ] SMS only
- [ ] Email only
- [ ] Not required for Phase 1

Business phone numbers

How many staff need their own business line? _____

Shared company line OK? [ ] Yes [ ] No

Templates

Why this matters
Templates = saved message drafts with blanks like {{first_name}} that fill in automatically.

- [ ] Need saved SMS / email templates with merge fields (name, links, ...)
- [ ] Not needed yet

06 CLIENT / PARTNER PORTALS

Why this matters
A portal is a private website for outsiders. Clients upload docs or pay; partners see referrals. Without a portal, everything stays in email/WhatsApp.

- [ ] No portal in Phase 1
- [ ] Client portal (tasks, docs, status, reports)
- [ ] Partner / affiliate portal
- [ ] Magic-link login (no password) preferred
- [ ] Password / OTP login preferred

Why this matters
OTP = one-time code sent by SMS/email to sign in.

Portal must support

- [ ] Document upload (ID, contracts, proof of address, photos, ...)
- [ ] Task checklist / onboarding steps with approval
- [ ] View progress reports / PDFs
- [ ] Pay an invoice / installment
- [ ] Book / confirm appointments
- [ ] Other: _____

07 PAYMENTS & BILLING

Why this matters
Installments = split a total into scheduled payments. Subscription = charges repeat monthly. Payment link = client pays from a secure URL (no card shared by text).

- [ ] Not needed in Phase 1
- [ ] One-time checkout
- [ ] Payment plans / installments
- [ ] Recurring subscriptions
- [ ] Collect card on file
- [ ] Send payment links by SMS / email
- [ ] Partner / affiliate commissions
- [ ] Invoicing / statements export

Processor preference (if any)

Why this matters
Processor = the company that charges cards (Stripe, Authorize.net). You do not need to decide today.

- [ ] Stripe [ ] Authorize.net [ ] Other: _____ [ ] Undecided

Collections workflow needed?

- [ ] Yes - overdue alerts to staff and/or client
- [ ] Soft reminders only
- [ ] No

08 DOCUMENTS, FORMS & APPROVALS

Why this matters
List the files you always collect (driver license, contract, photos, city plans). "Approval" means a staff member must click OK before work continues.

Document types to store (list the important ones)

Upload size / type constraints we should know about

Approvals

- [ ] Staff must approve client uploads before next stage
- [ ] Client signs / acknowledges documents
- [ ] No formal approval flow

Existing storage to migrate?

- [ ] Google Drive / Dropbox [ ] Email attachments [ ] Other: _____
- [ ] None - start clean

09 SCHEDULING, REMINDERS & CALENDAR

Why this matters
Reminders = automatic "your install is in 3 days" messages. Tell us who should get them (client, your team, or both).

- [ ] Not needed in Phase 1
- [ ] Job / install start dates
- [ ] Round / recurring milestones (e.g. every 45 days)
- [ ] Appointment booking
- [ ] Automated reminders before a date

If reminders: who gets them?

- [ ] Client only
- [ ] Internal team only
- [ ] Both

Preferred timing (e.g. 3 days before, then 1 day before)

What does "client ready" mean before work starts?

Why this matters
Example: site cleared, deposit paid, permit approved, keys available.

10 FIELD / OPERATIONS (if applicable)

Why this matters
Skip this section if your team works only from an office or remotely. "Field" = people on-site who need to update status or upload photos from a phone.

- [ ] Not applicable (office / remote business)
- [ ] City / county plan or permit tracking
- [ ] Materials / vendor order -> ship -> deliver tracking
- [ ] Photo proof of work from the field
- [ ] Inspection / punch-list closeout

Cities / portals / vendors to integrate or track (list top ones)

Do those systems have logins, tracking IDs, or APIs?

Why this matters
API = a technical connection so systems talk automatically. If you only check a website by hand, say "portal login" or "manual."

- [ ] Portal login + tracking number
- [ ] Email status only
- [ ] Phone / manual check
- [ ] API available (share docs if yes)
- [ ] Unknown

11 INTEGRATIONS

Why this matters
Integrations = connecting tools you already use (phone, email, accounting) so you do not re-type data. "Standalone first" is fine for Phase 1.

Check anything you already use or want connected

- [ ] Twilio (SMS / voice)
- [ ] Email provider (Resend / SendGrid / Google Workspace)
- [ ] HubSpot or other CRM sync
- [ ] Credit / bureau / vendor APIs (name): _____
- [ ] Accounting (QuickBooks, etc.)
- [ ] Calendar (Google / Outlook)
- [ ] Maps / routing
- [ ] Other: _____
- [ ] None - build standalone first

Must-keep tools that cannot be replaced in Phase 1

12 REPORTING, DASHBOARDS & AI

Why this matters
Dashboard = one screen with the numbers you check every morning (open jobs, overdue payments, unread messages). AI is optional - staff still approve before anything sends.

Top 3-5 things for a daily dashboard glance

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Reports you currently build by hand that should be automated

AI / assistant interest (optional)

- ☐ Staff AI that can search CRM and draft SMS/email (with approval)
- ☐ Call / voicemail summaries
- ☐ Document / report generation
- ☐ Not interested yet

13 BRANDING, MULTI-LOCATION, WHITE-LABEL

Why this matters
White-label = later you could resell a version of this software under your own brand to other companies. Not required for launch.

- ☐ Single brand / single company
- ☐ Multiple locations / teams under one company
- ☐ Want white-label / resale to other companies later (Phase 2+)

If white-label later: first industry you would resell to?

Public website needed with the platform?

- ☐ Yes - marketing site + app
- ☐ App / portal only (we already have a site)
- ☐ Redesign existing site as part of project

14 SECURITY, COMPLIANCE & ACCESS

Why this matters
Tell us if you store sensitive data (SSN, credit reports, medical). That changes how we lock files and who can see what.

- ☐ Standard business data
- ☐ Sensitive personal / financial data (SSN, credit, banking)
- ☐ HIPAA or other regulated data (describe): _____

Audit / logging needs

Why this matters
Audit log = a history of who did what (sent SMS, downloaded a file, logged in).

- ☐ Who sent what message / when
- ☐ Who viewed or downloaded files
- ☐ Login history

Staff access model

- ☐ Everyone sees everything
- ☐ Role-based permissions
- ☐ Assigned-only (see own book of business)

15 PRIORITY & PHASE 1 CUT LINE

Why this matters
Phase 1 should be the 1-2 outcomes that would make the biggest difference if finished first. Everything else can wait for Phase 2.

Rank the top 2 outcomes that must ship first

#1 _____
#2 _____

What can wait for Phase 2?

Hard constraints
Budget ballpark (optional): _____
Hard deadline (if any): _____
Decision maker who signs off: _____

16 ATTACHMENTS TO SEND BACK

Discovery Checklist

Platform requirements intake

Why this matters

Rough is fine - screenshots, photos of a whiteboard, or a sample anonymized customer record help more than a perfect document.

Please attach whatever you already have - even rough:

- [ ] Org chart or list of roles + names
- [ ] Current pipeline stages (screenshot or list)
- [ ] Sample client / job record (anonymized OK)
- [ ] Sample documents you collect
- [ ] Example reminder or SMS you send today
- [ ] Export or screenshots of current CRM / portal
- [ ] Vendor / city portal list with example tracking IDs
- [ ] Logo files + brand colors (if known)
- [ ] Domain name(s) you want to use

NEXT STEP

Why this matters

Incomplete answers are OK. Return what you can - we will fill gaps on the call.

Return this completed quiz. We will reply with a scoped Phase 1 proposal - modules, timeline, and cost - then schedule a follow-up call to confirm.